

Dental emergency: scoping review protocol

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Abstract

Introduction: considering the high prevalence of dental caries, understand the factors that may influence the use of network health services in dental emergency cases is important to improve the access and qualify the emergency net care (ENC). To provide an overview about this field in Brazil we consider performing a scoping review. The aim of this publication is to present the protocol of a scoping review about dental emergency in public health services in Brazil.

Methods and analysis: the review will follow the Joanna Briggs Institute scoping review methods protocol. We will search for relevant studies in MEDLINE, EMBASE, SCIELO and perform a gray literature search using Google Scholar. Two independent reviewers will select the articles. Discrepancies will be solved through discussion and, in case of disagreement, with a third reviewer. Descriptive statistical analysis will be performed.

Ethics and dissemination: A paper summarizing the findings from this review will be published in a peer-reviewed journal. Ethical approval is not required.

Strengths and limitations of the study

Results from this scoping review will contribute to a broader perspective of the factors and gaps that influence the use of network health services in dental emergency care in Brazil.

A potential limitation could be the small number of eligible articles in the literature.

As this is a scoping review, the quality of the evidence will not be assessed.

Keywords: emergencies, oral health, health services, health care

Introduction

Dental emergency is associated with high prevalence of dental caries, disparities and access to dental care¹. Health care in Brazilian health system is organized as a network^{1,2}. Understand the use of the different points of the net for dental emergencies care is important to improve the access and qualify the dental emergency network care³.

To provide an overview about this field in Brazil, a scoping review will be performed. Scoping reviews are a recent type of knowledge synthesis which systematically maps evidence on a specific subject matter, identifying key concepts, theories, sources of evidence, and research⁴.

Reporting guidelines to provide information about how the research will be conducted and allow the analysis of the quality and the reproduction of the research is already usual in clinical trials. Considering the iterative nature of a scoping review, to provide researchers with a methodologic protocol, the Joanna Briggs Institute and collaborators developed a guideline for scoping review protocols. Following these guidelines, this document presents a protocol of a scoping review on dental emergency care provision in Brazil's National Health System⁵.

Review question, objectives and context

The topic of interest is dental emergencies in Brazil. The research question is: what has been studied on the use of dental emergency care network in Brazil's National Health System public services? The question encompasses the concept of emergency in dentistry, user-related factors, as well as the organization of the emergency care network, its components and organizational principles. The aims

are to map the literature about dental emergencies in Brazil's network of public health care services, describe the factors that modulate the use and access to such services and describe the gaps in literature.

Inclusion Criteria

The pre-established criterion of inclusion is to be an article about dental emergency care in the context of Brazilian National Health System.

Exclusion Criteria

The research question per se excludes other countries than Brazil and private services, be them fee for service or paid by private insurance. In the analysis process of the studies, further exclusion criteria's can be defined.

Type of participants

This study is focused in articles that provide dental emergency care in public services that are organized as part of the emergency care network in primary, secondary or tertiary points of care.

Concept

To understand how the use of services in the network occurs and factors that modulate the access to health services we will use the behavioral model of Andersen. The model bases itself on the fact that improved access to care is more properly addressed and explained through the relationship between predisposing, enabling, need, health behaviors and outcomes, considering contextual and individual factors and is presented in appendix 1⁴.

Research and study selection

This scoping review will follow the five steps proposed by Ashley and O'Malley: (1) identifying the research question, (2) identifying relevant studies, (3) selecting studies, (4) collecting data, (5) mapping, summarizing and describing

the results⁶. In order to build the search strategy, an adapted version of the PECO question will be adopted (P: patient, E: exposure, C: comparison, O: outcomes), turning into PEC, in which “P” means the population (users), “E” means exposure of interest (dental emergency), “C” means the context (point of care within the health care network)⁷.

The health descriptors and the combinations to build the strategies will be “emergencies”, “emergency”, “oral health”, “dentistry” and “health services” with Boolean operators such as “AND” and “OR”. The search will be carried out in the Medline (PubMed), Embase and Web of Science databases from their beginning until September of 2018. Also, the search was conducted in the gray literature using Google Scholar search engine.

To identify articles potentially eligible for the study, titles and abstracts will be read and analyzed and the selected studies will be fully read by two independent reviewers (KF, CMS), when relevant, data will be extract. If further information is needed, we will contact the authors of the included studies. Any disagreement will be solved by discussion. In case of no agreement, a third reviewer will be consulted (FNH). To organize the screening and data extraction a reference management software will be used.

Extracting and charting results

The data extraction will be performed in Excel files. The data extracted will be author, year of publication, journal, emergency concept, objectives, methodology (setting, design, population/sample, duration, outcome and exploratory variables) and results. The studies will be classified according to the point of emergency care network and according to the components of behavioral

model, like the methodology used by Worsley et al., that evaluated access to dental emergency services^{4,8}.

Synthesis and reporting of results

The general characteristics of included studies will be summarized. Descriptive statistical analysis will be performed. The data of the selected studies will be organized as determinant factors and gaps in use of dental emergency services following Andersen model. A paper summarizing the findings from this review will be published in a peer-reviewed journal. Prisma extension for scoping review will be used to report this review⁹.

Funding

None.

Authors' contributions

All authors contributed to conceptualizing and designing the study. KF will drafted the protocol and CMS and FNH will made major revisions. All authors will read and approved the final version of the protocol. The same process will be used to write the final manuscript.

Competing interests

None.

Ethics approval

Not required.

Discussion

The results will be discussed in the context of the current literature, practice and policy.

Conclusion and implications for research and practice

This research intends to give a wide picture of dental emergency network care and explore the research gaps. It is expected that the results of this review can help managers, professionals and researchers in the area of health services and systems, specifically in what pertains to the dental emergency network of care.

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Appendix

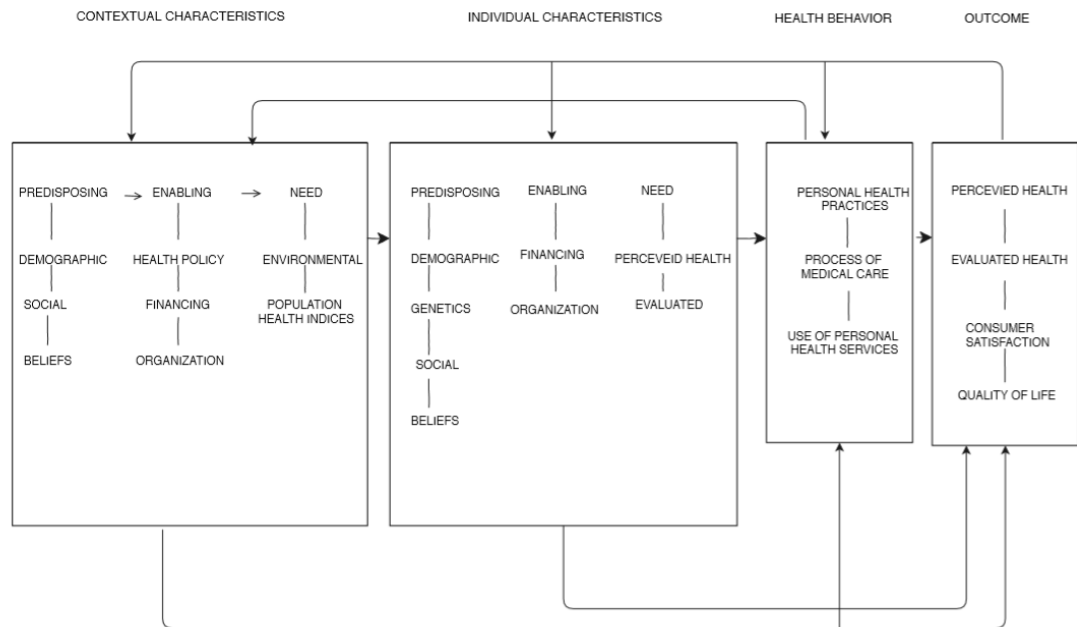


Figure 1. A behavioral model of health services use including contextual and individual characteristics³